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Ideas Exclusively For Publishers and Marketers of Information Products

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Mike Heatley of the DFW Land Advisory markets land investments via direct-mail and asks (1) how can we get wealthy individuals to call us?, (2) how can we be perceived as experts in our business?

Mike, I recently put together a direct-mail campaign for a planned community developer in western Canada that "sold out' $600,000.00 in investments in less than 90 days. I liked a lot of the sample letter of yours that you sent me, by the way. "Hot dang! Bring in the dancing bears." - a great line. Anyway, to your questions: to be perceived as experts, the very best thing you can do is publish and be published, including (a) write and publish your own book, which can become your calling card, (b) publish a newsletter or series of 'white papers' or reports and send them free, frequently, to a target list of prospects and centers-of-influence, (c) get articles published, and (d) seek publicity in your city or industry. I recommend Paul Hartunian's publicity course. Call my office for Paul's number if you like. Next, you get wealthy individuals to call you exactly the same way you get poor people to call you or get pidgeons to a windowsill, rats into an alley or kids to come in out of the backyard: you need the right magnet. People don't spend enough time figuring out exactly what their magnet ought to be and how it ought to be described and presented. A few "content clues": what or who is your prospective investor bitterly, violently mad at? What is their biggest, most painful headache? What is their biggest nagging problem?

Feature: WHAT HAPPENS IF YOUR TIRE BLOWS OUT WHILE YOU'RE RACING UP THE ON-RAMP TO THE ELECTRONIC SUPER HYPE-WAY?

I promised you some frank talk about the information super-highway, and here it is.

In The Washington Post (4/6) reporters Paul Farhi and Sandra Sugawara noted: " The reality of the information superhighway is catching up with the rhetoric."

That comment was sparked by the very recent collapse of three different, high profile, mega-money business deals touted as the big breakthroughs that would quickly run the entire superhighway right through every living room, office and shop in America. Let's remember that it took 70 years to get half the nation wired for phone service and my cable TV still goes out whenever it rains, it's windy, there's a Suns game on, or the rare night that there's something on HBO worth watching.

It's going to take at least 200-Billion Dollars to run this new superhighway into 95 million homes, via high capacity fiber optic cable. And the failure of Cox and SW Bell to go through with their merger AND the federal government's interference with AT&T's plan to enter wireless via the 12 billion dollar purchase of McCaw Cellular AND the collapse of the Bell Atlantic-TCI deal add up to the construction of all the on ramps stalled. For how long? Who knows? Analysts at Forester Research, one of the biggest think tanks immersed in all this now predict "the year 2,000 as the EARLIEST possible date for any significant emergence of interactive TV."

In other words, everybody running around predicting a computer in every house, people doing all their shopping and banking through the TV, the demise of movie theaters as 1,000 movie choices come through TV, etc., etc. - well, they've jumped the gun just a little bit. Probably by a decade. So let's calm down.

And let's calmly look at all the hype about getting rich overnight by marketing via computer bulletin boards, on line services and Internet. To read or listen to some of this stuff, you would get the impression that you can now advertise and e-mail to millions of people at no cost, and sit back and watch the money bleep back in. Well, it's not really *that* simple.

Even The Toughest Door-To-Door Salesman
Knew Better Than To Waste Time In Hudson Falls -

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The Residents Had Made A Pact
To Slam Their Doors In Any Salesman's Face,
And The City Had A "No Soliciting" Ordinance Too

Door-to-door salesmen started bumping against laws passed by communities prohibiting them beginning in the 1960's. In most communities where the people decided they did not want door-to-door salesmen, that was it. Even if you dared go in there and knock on doors, even if you were giving away gold bars, no takers, because they had decided "no salesmen".

In the April SUCCESS Magazine, Norman Dolph notes that there are now a staggering 15 million Internet users, with 150,000 more signing on in an average month - but a warning: "Internet is NOT to be used for starkly commercial purposes. You CAN'T advertise on it except for simple buy/sell classifieds." He goes on to acknowledge that "the question of what is commercial gets stretched daily", but make no mistake about it - his comments represent an Attitude of many of those 15 million...that you, the crass marketer attempting to use Internet for those "starkly commercial purposes" are wholly unwelcome, a moneychanger who should be forcibly driven from the temple, a heathen, a nuisance, a criminal element fouling their environment. Gee, with that as their Attitude, selling to them ought to be a ball.

Incidentally, roughly 27% of the American households *do* have a computer. Recent surveys show that 80% are IBM compats, 20% Apple; 60% of the owners are college grads; but the machines are overwhelmingly used as word processors, then for entertainment and games. There is a rush in sign-ups to the online services ie. America OnLine, CompuServe and Prodigy, but it's too early in that game to draw any reliable conclusions about the percentage who use the services and what they use them for.....although there's some evidence to suggest a lot of the use has to do with "computer sex" of one kind or another. And government agencies like the FBI and the USPS Inspectors make the point that communication by computer is now the favored method of pedophiles, dope smgglers, and assorted other criminals - so they are stepping up their monitoring of computer bulletin board and e-mail activity. Big Brother is on line.

What does all this have to do with the price of salami? Well, first of all, let's acknowledge that we do not yet know much about what the Internet users will and will not respond to, how to segment them, how to do targeted marketing to them, and how to aggressively promote while avoiding raising their ire. (And they will attack. One method is called "flameing." It is just as unpleasant as it sounds.) If you think for one minute that direct marketers will get away with flooding the system with "junk e-mail" very long, you're in dream-land. These folks will act very quickly to get laws with real teeth passed and enforced, they will fight back within their own system, they may sue advertisers (see comments about broadcast FAX later in this article).

At best, if huge numbers of these people are stubbornly, militantly non-responsive to the invasion of the "starkly commercial," then the ability to deliver millions of messages to them at the bump of a button is of very, very questionable value. If this is an environment hostile to the salesman, then being able to drop my salesmen in their with very little cost is of equally little value.

Let's remember - Gary! - the value of "the starving crowd." One of the things I want is a *responsive* market.

Second, let's acknowledge that open, undisguised and permitted direct marketing via the services, like CompuServe and Prodigy is actually working well for some, very modestly for others, and not at all for most. There are impressive success stories, but compared to those of other media that is much more predictable, readily available, and still under-exploited, these successes are small in number and in total size. This year, in "my field", Ted Nicholas and Entrepreneur Magazine are among the advertisers paying CompuServe about $12,000.00 for a full year's advertising in their "Mall." It will be interesting to see if they and similar advertisers repeat. Or expand.

Third, let's acknowledge that many of the successes of marketing via computer bulletin boards are very, very labor and time intensive. You are actually parked there, plugged into your computer, answering questions, dealing with people one on one or in small groups, and responding to e-mail all day, everyday. Okay for some, but no panacea. I can put a regular mail-

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order business with print media 100% on auto-pilot. Nobody has shown me that opportunity here. And, marketing through the staggering number of independent computer bulletin boards out there seems to me to be a terrible logistics problem. (AccessNet, introduced later in this article, is trying to organize these folks as we speak.)

Fourth, there are "service bureaus" popping up constantly, promising to "do it for you" and make you rich. Believe it or not, I get called and pitched by a new one at least once a week. If pressed, most cannot document and prove their claimed successes. They cannot furnish legitimate client testimonials. Their promises are to be looked upon with great suspicion. This whole thing reminds me a great deal of the 900# business: there are at least 1,000-times more promoters insisting that anybody can get rich in 900 than there are people who have ever made even a dime from a 900 number. And, if you take out just a few "product categories" that work in 900 -- hard core sex, soft core sex, gambling, psychics and astrology -- you have darned few successes left to hold up and shout about. I suspect that, too, is the case here; that there are a few "product categories" that will work well, and only a few.

Now, with all that said - and being accused of being a guy resistant to change, naysaying the phone in favor of the pigeon even as Bell and Watson converse, let me get on record that I am in favor of the entrepreneur, particularly the 'information entrepreneur' exploring, investigating and even experimenting with all this. But I think you need to remember that is what you are doing; devoting a certain amount of time and money to research and preparation for the future, to be positioned for new opportunities. If you approach this from that angle, I'm all for you. But if you insist on trying to somehow make a bundle right now, then I think you're a goof. And if you let yourself get so seduced by technology that you turn your back on more reliable, predictable, currently profitable media and methods, you'll soon be a bankrupt goof.

Most people have limited resources. They cannot do everything, try everything, use every media, say yes to every opportunity. They have to pick and choose. If that describes you, then wandering off where no man has gone before can't be one of your best choices. But, because you insist:

There Goes Diogenes....

I know of several people doing what appear to be really good work, finding ways you can benefit and profit from computers - and not all these ways have to do with selling something. In terms of access to information, to important contacts, doing research, testing new ideas, there's more value, in my opinion, than in the hyped areas. Anyway, here's my list:

PAUL GILSTER has written a guide called THE INTERNET NAVIGATOR. It's explained in Norman Delph's article in the April Issue of Success Magazine. At least a half-dozen subscribers and clients have told me that I should read it.

KEN Mc-CARTHY publishes a newsletter on Online Marketing and has an important seminar coming up in June. He has other info he'll be happy to share. And Ken is a 110% straight-shooter who really understands this stuff and is making it work. Call Ken at 415-928-4072.

There may be other folks worthy of mention, and if I've ommitted such a person, I apologize and am willing to add to my list.

People are gonna ask me: are *you* doing any of this? And the answer is no. Not yet. And I'll tell you why: I can't even take care of all the opportunity I've got in front of me, utilizing media I'm thoroughly familiar with. Heck, I'm more than a month late getting my 1994 catalog to the printer. I *just* accepted free space in several card decks, on a test basis, that was offered to me three months ago. Free! So, even though, on one hand, I know I should have my nose in this, I don't, and I won't for a while. Hopefully, several of my trusty subscribers will figure it all out - really - and wind up marketing me and my stuff along with theirs, and making me rich inspite of myself. Several have made me just such a promise.

Anyway, when I say "NO BS", I mean NO BS; not only does that promise straight talk about what I do know a lot about, it promises that I won't ever pretend to know something that I don't. And I cheerfully admit, in the land of megabytes and pooperwhoofers, cyberspace and sysops, you are on your own.

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IF YOU MUST PLAY THE 900# GAME....

...don't do it without reading Bob Mastin's giant book: 900 KNOW-HOW. Now in its 2nd Edition, this is, arguably, the most complete, honest and straightforward book on this industry. This new up-dated edition is listed for April availability, but Bob sent me one, I studied it cover to cover, and would tell anybody: don't venture into 900 without it. It's $19.95, 320 pages, from Aegis Publishing. 401/849-4200, or in some bookstores.

FOR THOSE INTERESTED IN 900-NUMBERS

Here are a few interesting, new applications: American Business Information has initiated Fax-A-List Service, for its business mailing lists, via 900-896-0000....San Diego's Municipal Court's answers to questions about traffic violations now cost 50 cents a minute, 900-505-9000....Con-Cur Disability Consultants offers advice on applying for Social Security disability benefits @ 900-446-4583, at a pricey $3.00 a minute...the Vicki! Show welcomes viewers comments at 75-cents for 40 seconds, 1-900-28-VICKI. The LA TIMES made $286,000.00 with a Cruise Sweepstakes promotion tied to a 900-number in February of this year. So, the death of 900 has been grossly exaggerated, there are still companies finding legitimate uses. Still, this IS a 'tough' business/media, due to increasingly complex and restrictive regulations. IN CANADA, 900 is new! Right now, very limited, but very soon, a big window of opportunity there.

Where Can Information Providers Make The Most Money In The Next 3 To 5 Years?

How would you like to get really, really RICH?

I have been telling my clients and seminar attendees about this for well over a year - there is a "trend" that is fueling a particular type of sale. In fact, it's a veritable Gold Rush. I'm in on it and you can be, too.

INC. Magazine Has Spotted This, Too

Rather than keep saying it myself, I'll quote the Editors of INC. MAGAZINE: "Watch for self-employment rates to rise rapidly in this country and, in the process, create a hot new market, and here's why: traditionally, there are three main factors affecting the rate of self-employment. Number one is demographic; people are more likely to choose self-employment as they get older, up until age 40, when the rate falls off. The second factor has to do with large company employment patterns, specifically the number and nature of jobs being created or eliminated. The third has emerged from recent studies of employment trends in Europe: self-employment is highest in countries with lots of government or legal intervention in the relationship between employer and employee.

"Now look at the situation here in the United States. The baby boomers, alas, are no longer babies; they have the means, the professional experience, and the mid life crisis necessary to propel them into self-employment."

"Meanwhile, downsizing in large companies will help the process along. And whatever else you think of those diverse folks in Washington, it's clear they have big plans for employer-employee relationships; more support for unions, mandated health-care benefits, mandated leave, mandated this, mandated

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that. We all know the effect of mandates on the job generation: it gets s-l-o-w."

He under-states the power of these forces, already driving an ever-increasing, relatively naive STAMPEDE of people to the franchise, business opportunity, and business opportunity information marketers. This market is likely to explode, to leap in size by 10,20, even 30-times its' recent size in the next year or so. That's why my clients in this field (like U.S. Gold) are making money hand over fist, like never before. That's why the Neiswonger-style $5,000 to $15,000 'business opportunity boot camps' are advertised with one and two page spreads in every conceivable magazine. And I could go on.

Here's What Most Of The Cows In The Stampede Look Like:

First, the baby boomer, midlife crisis person or couple, the maturing 'yuppie.' The Brady Kids, grown up. Second, the even bigger chunk of the stampede: downsizing, merger , acquisition and bankruptcy squeezed-out mid-level sales executives, salespeople and managers; white-collars without a snowball's chance in the Arizona desert of finding another comparable position with comparable earnings. It's just not going to happen. So these people have no hope of satisfactory replacement employment, they're accustomed to a pretty good income, and they have the financial ability to go into business, often significant equity in their homes, early retirement lump sum settlements, big severance pay checks and good credit.

Now, when I say 'stampede,' I mean 'stampede.' Look around. Count the numbers: how many jobs has IBM cut plus how many lay-offs. Sears. General Motors. McDonnell-Douglas. And for every headline-grabbing big dump of 10,000 or 20,000 jobs, there are another 10,000 or 20,000 "hidden," because they're two here, three there, from small companies dependent on the business they get from those big companies. We are in the midst of the largest, fastest shrinkage of the mid levels of corporate America that has ever taken place in the history of our nation. And I am here to tell you it is not going to stop. The more Clinton succeeds at tinkering with business, the fewer new jobs, the more cuts. At best, most small and mid-size business owners are resigned to waiting him out, they're already counting the remaining days of his Administration, and, in that interim, they are not going to take any of the bold steps that create jobs. And the few that go ahead and create and expand can't come close to matching the continued collapse of big business. This year, there'll be more white collar people out on the streets than during the worst days of the Depression. But this time, they have money and the entre-preneurial impulse.

What Does This Mean To You?

If you have a franchise, a business opportunity, a get-into-some-kind-of-business "training," a relevant book or course, or if you know how to make money in a specific business that others can succeed in, now is the time to put your pedal to the metal. And here's a plug: USE ME TO GET RICH. I know as much about marketing such things as anybody you could possibly find to help you. I currently have the longest running, most successful, most profitable business opportunity TV-infomercial on the air, and have otherwise helped that client twice increase his business by 50%+, with two different strategies, in the past 18 months. For another client, the full-page ad I developed for them is running every month in Success, Entrepreneur, all the lesser opportunity mags, and is flat-out sucking in money like a giant vacuum cleaner super-charged by Tim Allen. One of the biggest "boot camp" marketers in the country has wisely, recently retained me to jazz up, strengthen and expand his marketing. If you are already a client of mine in this category, turn up the jets! If you're not but should be, get to me.

If you have no way to step up to the plate with an opportunity offer for this stampede, then the next best place to position yourself is somehow serving these folks AFTER they get into some kind of business. And remember that many are "home-based businesses." A bank that finally gets its head out of its butt and takes a reasonable approach to setting up credit card merchant accounts for home-based businesses (and direct marketers) will make a fast fortune unlike anything ever seen in banking. But these homepreneurs need all sorts of other things, too. PC's, FAX machines, voice mail services- and the

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guy who provides leasing and financing for such things, for homepreneurs will also win very, very big.

Lifestyle Issues Are Very Important To These People, Too

Yep, all that stuff you read in Faith Popcorn's book is pretty much happening. And a lot of the new folks becoming self-employed are as concerned with lifestyle as they are money. That's why, for example, I just wrote this headline for a new promotion:

"WHILE I SAT IN THE GRANDSTAND AT MY SON'S LITTLE LEAGUE GAME,
I TOOK ONE CALL ON MY PORTABLE PHONE AND MADE $6,128.00.
THANKS TO THIS UNUSUAL BUSINESS, I HAVE LOTS OF TIME FOR MY
FAMILY AND STILL MAKE A GREAT INCOME."

Now, I believe you can go overboard with this. Get too far away from the good old reliables: greed, sex, and you're in trouble. But there is a new set of buying motives surfacing out there, and we need to listen to them, test them and use them as best we can.

REPORT FROM THE AMERICAN BOOKSELLERS ASSOC. CONVENTION

TED NICHOLAS* & I WERE TALKING AT THE ABA and we agreed that we are both unceasingly amazed at how many really lousy book titles that are out there! What so many publishers seem to ignore - because editors, not direct marketers create covers - is that the title and subtitle must work like the headline and subhead of an ad AND must cause the person to reach in amongst all the books on the shelf and grab that one book.

I saw a book with the title "Bottoms Up." The subtitle, in tiny little letters was: "How To Firm Your Buns And Trim Your Thighs In Just 24 Hours." Obviously, the subtitle ought to be the title, the title ought to be trashed. But somebody in their marketing department thought "Bottoms Up" was just so cute, so clever. Dumb. Dumb. Dumb.

HALF THE BATTLE is the title and the subtitle, the headline and the subhead.

*Ted, as most of you know, has sold over 200-million dollars worth of books, mostly via direct-response advertising and direct-mail, plus some bookstore distribution, and knows what it takes to make a book sell. He indicated that 5 or 6 of my customers/subscribers have signed up for his self-publishing seminar(s), and that's good. (You can reach Ted's Office at 813/596-4966.)

There were over 3,500 exhibitors at ABA, and as you stand on the 2nd floor and look out at all those exhibitors, you have to be amazed, maybe intimidated, maybe even overwhelmed - and there is immense opportunity there - but it's also important to remember that there is somewhat of an arrogant, inbred, myopic, snobbish industry, badly damaged by its own attitudes because ONLY 20% OF ALL BOOKS BOUGHT IN THE U.S. ARE BOUGHT IN BOOKSTORES. The publisher who looks down his nose at all other methods of distribution, such as mail-order marketers, cuts off his nose with 80% of his potential sales and markets.

Still, a little bit more about the "immense opportunity." I do believe in having a book or books published by "conventional publishers," and then working with those publishers, for several reasons:

A) Bookstore distribution - for me, that equals free advertising which is more important than royalties. My new book's generating 1 to 5 FAXes a day, requesting catalogs, newsletter info, etc. If I got those by advertising, they'd cost me $7 to $20 a lead. And these are better, because with them I already have considerable credibility thanks to the book. My ULTIMATE MARKETING PLAN book has brought in tens of thousands of dollars of speaking and consulting clients and projects I would not have obtained otherwise.

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B) Publicity and credibility - first of all, any publicity the publisher gets for me is publicity I didn't have to work or pay for. Frankly, my first publisher did very little of this. My second publisher (Self-Counsel Press) has done quite a bit, including hitting USA TODAY and Jane Applegate's nationally syndicated business column. And there is unmatched credibility from having bookstore distribution.

C) Opportunity - this year, by standing around in my publisher's booth and working the ABA Show, talking to booksellers and visitors (something most authors won't do and most publishers won't allow), a number of little things and two big things happened: one, I met a Producer for the Phil Donahue Show and had a very good, fairly long conversation; two, I met the owner of the ABA award-winning bookstore of the year (Nickelbys) and arranged a really great "author event" at their store, which I'll tell you more about another time.

Things can happen because you are an author published by a respected publishing house that cannot or would not occur otherwise.

D) Money - my advances have inched up from book to book, and the deal my agent just got me with Putnam has a darned good advance. The royalties are then pure passive income. My new book's first two months' sales have much more than covered the advance and I'll have a nice check coming. This book may very well make me $40,000 to $50,000 before it dies. Maybe that doesn't sound like a lot to you for all the work of writing a book, I don't know. But to me, since the free advertising alone is sufficient reason to do the book, this "extra" reward is significant. And, since I'm very organized, efficient and fast, that book represents only about 20 full days of work, so that breaks out to $2,000.00 a day, roughly equal to my in-Phoenix per day consulting fee minimum, so this gives me 20 days of non-travel-linked income.

Added Value From Other Work - all of my books include material from my seminars, research done for clients' projects and my own business projects, cassette courses, past issues of newsletters, and articles; work I've had to do anyway; so "regurgitating" it as a book is very attractive to me. THE ULTIMATE SALES LETTER was a re-write of a previously self-published manual and cassette, "How To Write A Million Dollar Sales Letter." 80% was a relatively easy re-write; 20% new work. THE NO BS, NO HOLDS BARRED, TAKE NO PRISONERS, KICK BUTT AND MAKE TONS OF MONEY BUSINESS SUCCESS BOOK was a re-write and expansion of my previously self-published 'Confessions Of An Entrepreneur.' Maybe 50%/50%. All of this is my material. I own all copyrights, all rights, so I can re-work it over and over again if I choose.

F) Free Editing - I've had good editors at every one of my publishers. Sally Germaine at Asher-Gallant Press, Brandon Toropov at Adams, Ruth Wilson at Self-Counsel, they have all taken my work and made it better. Chances are, over time, all these works will go out-of-print with the publishers and the publishing rights I licensed to them will revert to me; I'll be able to revise the works and place them with a different publisher or I'll self-publish them all over again...with the benefit of those fine editors' work.

G) An Agent - hey, it's nice to have somebody who is competent, respected in the publishing industry, working hard on my behalf, getting paid only for positive results.

NIMA INFOMERCIAL REPORT

AT NIMA, JOE CAPPO, A REGULAR COLUMNIST FOR 'ADVERTISING AGE' MAGAZINE STOOD UP AND STRUCK FEAR AND ENGENDERED LOATHING IN THE AD AGENCY TRADITIONALISTS IN THE ROOM WHEN HE SAID: "BY THE YEAR 2,000, MANY OF THE TRADITIONAL AD AGENCIES WILL BE IRRELEVANT."

Well, if their clients had the good sense and cajones to force them to provide accountable advertising now, the agencies wouldn't have to wait that

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long to be found irrelevant. That whole industry is the kid's fable of "the emperor with no clothes on" if I've ever seen one.

Actually, there's another "emperor" story that applies too. I first heard it in the movie "Serpico." Paraphrased: there's this little kingdom, everybody's dumb and happy. One day a medicine man comes to town, sees that everybody drinks from the same water supply, tests the water, sees that it's tainted, and warns everybody to stop drinking from that well. Except the king. The castle staff keeps getting their water from the well. In a few days, all the peasants have realized the king is as nutty as a fruitcake and there's rioting in the streets. The medicine man realizes he's causing the complete destruction of this monarchy, gets scared, so he tells everybody the water has been restored to purity and is again safe to drink. Everybody goes back to drinking the water. And in a few days, they're all rejoicing in the streets because their king has regained his sanity.

Anyway, subscriber Sam Lilly sent me a copy of Joe Cappo's own report on our NIMA Convention, from Ad Age, and I've reprinted it here. But let me tell you why the movement of major corporations into our infomer-cial world will be a whole lot slower (and 'uglier') than Joe Cappo and other observers think:

As long as the ad agencies can keep the clients drinking the bad water, infomercials will be viewed with skepticism and horror. Even though a company can do a 1/2-hour infomercial for LESS dough than the typical agency produced 1/2-MINUTE spot, infomercials can't be judged by ratings, Nielsen numbers and viewership, and that's how agencies count and have convinced their tainted-water-drinking clients to count, too. It IS insanity, but it's the way things are done nonetheless. Second, agency execs and corporate CEOs will not get the praise of their buddies at the country club for infomercials - in fact, they'll be ridiculed and made fun of. That'll slow the movement considerably. Third, most biggies who do try it, will do so with the usual bunch of clowns from their normal agencies, who will foul it up royally, then everybody can say "see, I told you this wasn't right for us" and go back to business as usual. Inspite of all this, there will be a creep of big business into infomercials, altering all the economics, and gradually closing the window of opportunity on entrepreneurs. I think there are a few years left.

Here's *Joe Cappo's* article:

INFOMERCIALS PUMP LIFE INTO ADVERTISING

You may find this hard to believe, but I recently attended a conference of the National Infomercial Marketing Assn.

Yes, that's right, the people who produce those half-hour televised sales pitches that run late at night and on Saturday and Sunday mornings have their own trade association. Not only that, but the meeting in New York's Plaza Hotel played to a full house of more than 500 attendees.

Why, you might ask, was I there? I attended the meeting because the infomercial business is growing rapidly while most other areas of advertising are facing tough times. There is the belief, promulgated by people like me, that there is a revolution taking place in advertising and marketing. Infomercials are part of the revolution.

You may laugh at the infomercial that hawks a spray paint to cover your bald spot (especially my bald spot), but this is serious business. That's why the program at the conference included representatives from respectable companies like Kodak and GTE relating great successes they have had in introducing new products or services through infomercials.

The concept works very well when a sponsor has something that cannot be easily explained in a 30-second television commercial. H. Ross Perot, still running for president even thoughthe election is over, can attest to that. His 30-minute infomercials allowed him to folksy up to the American public while explaining, as only he could, the problems our country is facing.

The infomercials did not win him the election. But they gave him an incredible amount of exposure and credibility.

Why would a big, reputable company monkey around with infomercials? The answer: They work. Most infomercials have a direct-response aspect to them. That is, when the program is running, viewers are usually urged to call a toll-free number to order a product or get a free sample. The response usually produces enough orders to pay for the programming time.

This is where traditional television advertising has a problem. An advertiser may run thousands of commercials over the course of a year, but doesn't know what kind of response, if any, the commercials produced from the audience.

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The other point that appeals to advertisers is economy. They usually can produce a 30-minute infomercial for the same cost as a traditional 30-second commercial. Production values are not as high on infomercials as on commercials, but if the infomercials sell product, then who cares?

The infomercial industry is not without its problems, perhaps the most serious of which is to clean out the rascals nd charlatans who use the medium to sell inferior products, or who don't fulfill orders or guarantee satisfaction. One purpose of the National Infomercial Marketing Assn. is to distance its members from the schlocksters by implementing a set of guidelines and a certification process.

This was one of the reasons that Janet Steiger, chairman of the Federal Trade Commission, was one of the speakers at the conference. The program also included appearances by a couple of infomercial "stars," former quarterback Fran Tarkenton, who co-hosts the "Tony Robbins Personal Power" show, and Susan Powter, the fitness-motivational guru who does the "Stop The Insanity" infomercial.

There is little question that more marketers are going to at least experiment with infomercials, if not move heavily into the medium. What is most interesting, though, is considering the position infomercials might hold in the coming 500-channel environment.

Is there a single person in this country looking forward to 500 channels of entertainment or even sports? No. We must assume that many of the channels will be devoted directly to marketing, not only infomercial channels, but also home-shopping channels on both broadcast and cable TV. When interactivity is added to cable, the potential for selling products becomes enormous.

The next move will probably be for retailers, especially catalog-oriented retailers, to put their goods on television. At the same time, many products introduced through infomercials and formerly sold exclusively on television are going into retail stores, with Montgomery Ward & Co. as one of the leading retailers.

Look, if this is a revolution, I want a front-row seat.

TELE-MARKETING: INFOCISION KEEPS RINGING UP HUGE SALES RESULTS FOR MANY INFOMERCIAL COMPANIES & OTHER DIRECT MARKETING CLIENTS.

I you turn big numbers of leads or customres, i.e. 10,000 to 100,000 or more per month or couple of months, you could reap huge added revenues from a back-end, relationship-based outbound telemarketing program completely handled for you by the experts at InfoCision. As I've said before, I have never seen a "cleaner," more reputable, more professional telemarketing operation. These folks have their act together in every way.

TV DIRECT-RESPONSE & INFOMERCIALS

Here are results from a recent survey of TV direct-response buyers:

1) The commercial accurately described the product I bought. 78% Agree; 20% disagree; 2% Unknown.

2) I was satisfied with the professionalism of the operator who took my order. *84% Agree, 14.5% Disagree; 1.5% Don't Know.

3) I was confident the company would stand behind the product and guarantee. 70%** Agree, 27.5% Disagree, 2.5% Unknown.

4) I would consider purchasing more products from an infomercial. 68% Agree, 30% Disagree***, 2% Unknown.

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5) When you purchased, how many times had you seen the infomercial? First time: 24%, 2-3 times: 46%, 4-5 times: 14%, 6+ times: 12%, Unknown: 5%.

(Source: RESPONSE TV MAGAZINE, July 1993.)

Some comments....*this 84% figure makes me question the veracity or intelligence of the respondents! Frankly, most incoming calls are handled with mediocrity throughout the industry. However, maybe this says that consumers' expectations in this area are relatively low. ** This 70% leaves 30% LACKING CONFIDENCE - so imagine the non-buyers; creating credibility and believability is important, so guarantees require emphasis and support. Do NOT assume just because you offer one that it and you are believed. ***This is deplorable, and as an industry, we better do something about it. I'm always harping on TCV, Total Customer Value. Every product delivered should so exceed the buyer's expectations that we wind up with a whole hunk of customers who would rather buy from infomercials than from any other source - just as QVC has its group of such customers.

Question #5 shows what I've long believed: it requires repetition in the same markets or on the same cable network, in roughly the same time slots, before a show can be accurately judged - because 72% of the orders come only after repeated viewing.

This just further reinforces what we know about all types of direct marketing (that most do NOT know; that is OUR 'secret'): REPETITION is the key to success. In direct-mail, we have proven that a sequence of mailings or repeated mailings of the same piece in a condensed period of time far surpasses results from one-shot mailings. Now the same 'principle' is being uncovered in television.

By the way, when I say 'secret,' I mean it. Very few pros in direct-mail understand the sequence. I virtually invented it. Very few others understand it. Many reject the strategy out-of-hand without ever testing, they are so set in their ways. When I teach you this approach, I really am putting something very unusual and valuable in your hands.

HOW TO MARKET "AGAINST AN ENEMY" - A STRATEGY FOR OUR TIMES.

OK, HERE'S HARD RESEARCH DATA YOU CAN USE: FOR MARKETERS OF FINANCIAL SERVICES AND PRODUCTS, WHO FRIGHENS THE PUBLIC MORE: BILL OR HILLARY? The publishers of a tax/financial newsletter recently tested their successful "control" direct-mail piece with the picture of Bill Clinton on the cover, and a "scare headline" about his tax plans vs. a new piece, with a picture of Hillary on the cover and the headline next to her photo "The Mother Of All Tax Burdens." The old control pulled 11.5 orders per 1,000; the new piece pulled 15 per 1,000.

If you're a CFP, insurance sales professional, accountant, newletter publisher, book publisher...if you can use Clinton to frighten your customers into attentiveness toward your message...this clearly shows that Hillary will work better for you than Bill. (By the way, have you seen the bumper-sticker:

IMPEACH CLINTON
And Throw Her Husband Out Too.

Don't underestimate her ability to rile up the emotions of your market!)

(Source: What's Working 6/28/93.)

THE BILL/HILLARY TEST REVEALS A BIG MONEY MAKING SECRET:

Now, let's talk about "the enemy sell."

Starting with "How To Form Your Own Corporation Without A Lawyer For Under $75," then with his "Corporate Book Of Forms," Ted Nicholas made a fortune positioned AGAINST lawyers. (Dan Quayle got some points once with this

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very same approach.) And lawyers ARE easy targets! But the lesson here is to sell against an enemy.

Other good enemies are: the Clintons - as described above; government; bureaucrats; and congress....medical doctors and 'the medical system'...thugs, gangs, crack-head rapists and vicious robbers roaming the streets... Politicians long ago learned that it is much easier to "fire'em up" AGAINST something than FOR something. The worst, most effective examples of this feature Hitler, the Klu Klux Klan, and others of that ilk. Watch and listen carefully and you'll see that every popular leader, every great movement has a formidable enemy, for everybody to be against. Oh, and by the way, one of my "best kept secrets," as a marketer, and as a speaker/platform salesperson, is the book THE TRUE BE-LIEVER by Eric Hoffer. If you haven't read it, get it and do so. There's never been a more thorough blueprint for mass persuasion, although that wasn't the author's intent.

In the last Issue of THE NO BS LETTER, I, and Jeff Paul, wrote about "emotional marketing." Nothing fires up the emotions better than ANGER. In Glenn Turner's classic recruiting speech for Dare To Be Great! and Koscot -- a speech that persuaded hundreds of thousands of people to each part with $5,000.00 -- he delivers a "punch line," after careful build-up: "They're pulling the strings and you're just dancin' to them" and when he delivers it, the crowd grumbles, groans, hisses. Their anger at somehow being controlled and being taken advantage of sets them up for the solution he will then offer.

In my current speech used at the events with Zig Ziglar and Peter Lowe, early in the presentation, I set up "traditional advertising" as the purse-robbing enemy of the small business owners in the audience...I call them "advertising VICTIMS"; and, for the salespeople, I point to "old-fashioned cold prospecting grunt work" as the enemy that sucks up all their time and energy. In my positioning for the "NO BS" book, I point to all the "theorists" writing business books as an enemy. I give this some thought and some play in just about every marketing project.

HOW TO SELL TONS OF "INFORMATION PRODUCTS"

This Report introduces a new resource **guaranteed** to prove immediately and immensely valuable to **you** - or I'll refund its cost AND give you an extra $10...ten bucks out of MY pocket, just for taking the time to try it. So, it'll pay you to read every word of this Report carefully.

Dear Direct Marketing Colleague:

My name is Dan Kennedy. I think I know more about making money with "information products" than anybody else on this planet. With this Report and its remarkable offer, I'll prove that to you - and show you how to dramatically improve the financial aspects of your business, your corporation's businesses, or your clients' businesses.

Some 'secrets' YOU may find value in knowing....

* The 'secrets' of a man who started with a "dirt cheap" 1-inch classified magazine ad and sold over 900,000 copies of his book AND became a major force in the business book field in less than 5 years (recently).

* How one author/marketer sold 180,000 copies of his $19 book, all via **free** advertising.

* How to take information you deliver in a seminar and convert it to not one but dozens of different types of Information Products that can be promoted nearly 100 different ways.

* **Proven formulas for selling "big ticket" items**...home study courses, seminars, subscriptions, even services...by mail!

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* Speakers & Seminar Promoters; how to sell Information Products to 15% to 25% of the 'non-buyers' in each audience - within 72 hours after the seminar. (This has enormous impact on the overall profitability of a seminar business.)

* How to use THE cheapest direct-mail device: the lowly postcard in brand new ways...how to cheaply test new offers and to (at least) DOUBLE the number of leads generated in card decks...

* How to take sales letters getting 1/4th% to 1% and make them pull 5% to 10%.

* "A-to-Z" about newest marketing opportunities & technologies: TV-infomercials, 900 numbers, recorded messages, etc.

I have spent 12 years learning, assembling 'expensive experience' and making millions of dollars as an Information Entrepreneur. I can tear the lid off your income, too. CONSIDER THE KIND OF PEOPLE WHO RELY ON ME FOR ADVICE IN THIS FIELD:

* GREG RENKER and Bill Guthy at the Guthy-Renker Corporation, one of the biggest, fastest-growing leaders in the "hot" Infomercial Business...responsible for Tony Robbins' PERSONAL POWER, the KATHY SMITH weight loss program, etc. - they have ready access to the best marketing minds...they choose to involve me, one way or another, in nearly every one of their projects!!! (Ask how I breathed new life into their "Think And Grow Rich" infomercial, increased the product price, and helped sell nearly 5-Million Dollars worth of Courses!)

* GARY HALBERT, the famous (and controversial) direct response expert who charges a whopping $7,000.00-per-person to attend his seminars and averages over 30 eager attendees at each one - he insists that I lecture at every one of them!

* RODNEY BUSCHER, co-founder of FNN (Financial News Network)...producer of infomercials and commercials...and man behind countless financial promotions.

And I could fill another 2 pages; my advice has made hundreds-of-thousands to millions of dollars for every person on that lengthy list! And, here's more **proof** that I deserve **your** attention...10 FACTS that prove I can show you how to derive the maximum possible profits from any type of Information Products business:

FACT #1: My Full-Page Ads have appeared **repeatedly** in Success, Opportunity, Entrepreneur, airline magazines, and dozens of other publications - producing Huge Profits for my own companies and my clients! Recently I "invented" a new way to take a successful ad that was "petering out" from long-term use and give it new life - worth thousands to my client each month, maybe $100,000 or more this year alone! (Before you spend another nickel on advertising, you ought to know what I know.)

FACT #2: Millions of dollars of my own Information Products have been sold worldwide through my own efforts...also Entrepreneur, Nightingale-Conant and others...and, counting clients, joint ventures, etc., I've been involved with **sales well over 30-million dollars** worth of Information Products AND that number goes up DAILY!

FACT #3: I'm Author, Co-Author, Editor or Ghost Writer of many enormously successful Information Products...including the Think And Grow Rich Business Reports (a premium)...the 'Psycho-Cybernetics' program sold by Nightingale-Conant, soon to be nationally advertised on TV..."Entrepreneur Magazine Presents: The 'Be Your Own Boss' System," co-authored with Tony

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Robbins and Fran Tarkenton...MANY books, newsletters, audios, videos, from $9.95 to $899.95....

FACT #4: I have "invented" at least a dozen new, innovative strategies for increasing profits of Information Products, each while solving a client's particular problem.

FACT #5: I've been involved with over a dozen TV-Infomercials; DM News published my article on this business. Guthy-Renker Corp., Quantum, HSN, and a number of independent producers rely on my expertise. I wrote and produced the #1 best producing, longest running "lead generation" infomercial in the business.

FACT #6: In 1983 and 1984, I developed **the largest** integrated seminar and publishing business exclusively serving the chiropractic and dental professions throughout the U.S. and Canada...hosted seminars in 42 states and every Canadian province...and captured a 30% market share ALL via cost-effective direct-mail.

FACT #7: I'm also a **successful Newsletter Publisher.**

FACT #8: I know how to arrange Celebrity Spokespersons for various promotions, and have many excellent contacts in the entertainment industry.

FACT #9: I'm **routinely** paid $3,000+ per day; $15,000 per project as a Consultant...been gifted with a new Cadillac by one appreciative client...and have beaten "controls" established by top copywriters. MOST of my clients **repeatedly** retain me. Fitting new clients into my schedule is usually a tough challenge.*

FACT #10: I am the only person ever to assemble every insider secret about making Information Prodicts into one huge resource. ("People will get a hernia carrying it around," wrote Coach Bill Foster at Northwestern University.)

If all this sounds braggadocio to you, please understand: the time has long since passed when I felt any urge to toot my own horn just to hear the music. I've rattled off these facts for your benefit, not mine - to clearly demonstrate why you should and can trust what I can reveal to you about making obscene amounts of money in this field. Now, on the next 5 pages, there's a MASTER LIST of some of the most important subjects covered in my new 'superbook': THE ULTIMATE INFORMATION ENTREPRENEUR.

Take a highlighter and mark through each item of importance to you. I DARE YOU to go through the next 5 pages and not mark off a wealth of how-to's you **need** to know more about!

(*Yes, I am using this little promotion as a means of "fishing" for new clients, but that is not my primary purpose and I do not want a lot of new clients; I really can't fit them in. I only hope for one or two really, really interesting, intriguing, adrenalin-pumping clients with huge potential to surface. Frankly, it takes an opportunity to make - via fees and royalties and other "back end" - tens of thousands to hundreds of thousands of dollars just to get my creative juices going these days. So this is not just a 'puff piece' to flush out clients from the woods. And, if you'll keep reading, you'll find a guaranteed opportunity to tap into my knowledge base for peanuts.)

PARTIAL LIST OF CONTENTS

HOW TO PRODUCE YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS'

* 12 Steps To An Audio Product (with Flow Chart)
* 18 Steps To Video Product (with Flow Chart)
* How To save 25% to 75% From Most Video Production Quotes!
* 8 Steps To A Printed Product (with Flow Chart)
* How To Create And Sell A "Moneymaking/Business Opportunity"
* The 39 Best Kinds of "Information Products"
* How to turn one good idea into a huge product line

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* 21 "Insider Secrets" to creating 'Information Products' with **exceptional** sale appeal
* 1 key source of over 10,000 good 'Information Products' ideas

UNDERSTANDING AND PROFITING FROM "THE MONEY ISSUES"

* **How to replace up-front costs royalties** and: how to convert vendors to at-risk profit partners. (How a speaker/author got $25,000.00 worth of video production free! How to use this "model" to get hundreds of thousands of dollars of free services.)
* How To Raise Capital from private investors and how to structure deals
* How To make Pricing Decisions
* How To Avoid Going Broke While You're Getting Rich and Famous
* The importance, power and beauty of "Pure Passive Income"

PREPARING MARKETING MATERIALS FOR YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS'

* "Everything you need to know about what works and what does not (based on over
** Million-$ research and experience)
* The "A-to-Z" of: | Envelopes | Sales Letters | Brochures | Catalogs | All types of "direct mail package" enclosures | Lift Letters | Post Cards | Self-Mailers
* Audio Brochures and "Closer Tapes"
* Video Brochures - including "the secret of the 99 cent video"
* **17 Keys To Making THE ORDER FORM help close the sale!**
* 6 ways to add "sales pizazz" to the titles and headlines
* Samples of "bestselling titles," headlines and "themes"
* What you need to know about: | product photography | typesetting | commercial art

HOW TO MAKE BIG MONEY SELLING YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' WITH "CHEAP" CLASSIFIED ADVERTISING

* The 'best' media
* Classified ad copywriting tips
* The "2 Step" Model: the **certain** path to success with classifieds
* **How to place your classified ad in newspapers, magazines, tabloids, shoppers, etc. with just 1 phone call!**
* How to "key" and accurately track ad results
* How to get tax-free **cash** in the mail
* Amazing 'Cash History' Success Stories to learn from and steal ideas from

HOW TO BE A "BIG PLAYER" IN THE INFORMATION PRODUCTS BUSINESS WITH PRINT MEDIA/DISPLAY ADVERTISING

* How to get Agency Discounts...**special Mail-Order-Only discounts...First-Time Advertiser Discounts**...and save 17% to 50% off the "rate cards" (price lists) - only "chumps" pay quoted rates!!!
* **How to buy "remnant space" at 50% off (or better)**
* A very different way to instantly offset 50% to 100% of your advertising expenses - this is a critically important "trade secret"...without knowing this, you will lose money 9 out of 10 times you advertise! (Revealed: "how I made $12,000.00 from 1 phone call" and how this "model" makes it possible and profitable for you to buy Full Page Ads in national magazines for your "Information Products")
* Best, most Responsive Magazines...Best Sizes...Best Times To Advertise
* When and How to use "Advertorials"
* **How to get Big Results from Small ads**
* How to "key" and accurately track results

HOW TO CHOOSE THE RIGHT MAILING LISTS, TO PROFITABLY SELL YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' VIA DIRECT-MAIL

* How **not** to get ripped off! (Most beginners do)
* Where to learn about and "comparison shop" thousands of good lists
* How much to pay; how to save money

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* **How to "test"**
* When is a "good test" a bad test? - how to avoid the most frequently used list scam which "kills" thousands of unsuspecting beginners every day!
* How to get reputable brokers to **really** help you
* "Secret" sources of the hottest, best 'opportunity seeker' and 'self-help improvement buyer' lists
* What you **must** know about "selection options" with lists
* **The secret to picking the best 'selection option' with every list**
* About Canadian & other International Lists, markets & special opportunities.
* **5 Keys to choosing a 'Big Pay-Off,' High Response List for your offer**

MARKETING STRATEGIES OF SPECIAL IMPORTANCE WITH 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS'

* How to use Guarantees to boost response
* "The Charles Atlas Method" can double your profits
* The 2 Step Model
* **The "ultimate" marketing secret:** product-to-list matching and list-driven new product/offer development. (This is the key to the vault! When you "get" this, you'll know the #1 reason why post people fall when they try to market 'Information Products'...If you've flopped before, you'll know why...and you'll possess the most important pro-secret for success.)
* 12 Ways To Maximize "perceived Value"
* **59 Proven Direct Response Offers** for 'Information Products'
* Focus Groups: Pros, Cons, "Do It Yourself"
* 5 Sources of **free** market research
* **How to get Famous Celebrities to endorse your product**
* How to contact and successfully negotiate with clebrities
* How to profit "in tandem" with other marketers of 'Information Products' including "endorsed mailings," co-op promotions, joint ventures, etc.

HOW TO REALLY GET "FREE" ADVERTISING FOR YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS'

* How to get the Government to promote your products!
* **How to get on lots and lots of Radio Talk Shows**...be interviewed over the phone, long-distance...give out your 800#...sell your products!
* How to organize your own Publicity Campaign
* Our complete "How-To-Meet-The-Press" Kit
* **What makes "News Releases" work?**
* **How a News Release sold $180,000.00 worth of an 'information product'** - how to use this "model" to get over One Million Dollars of **free** nationwide advertising for your 'Information Products'
* How to cut all the costs of pursuing publicity by at least 50%
* Who can help you get free advertising?
* How to build a business purely with free advertising (Yes - You Can!)

UNUSUAL WAYS TO MAKE MONEY WITH YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS'

* How to sell by mail to **Libraries**
* How to sell by mail to the **Military**
* How to get **Bookstore Distribution** for "self-published products" (Yes - You Can!)
* How to take an 'Information Product' you've put into the marketplace yourself and convert it to a book that a major publisher will accept, publish, distribute and promote!
* How to exhibit your 'Information Product' to over 25,000 bookstore owners, chain store buyers, catalog house buyers and publishers for less than $1,500.00!
* How to get a literary agent who will aggressively promote you and your works.
* How to sell your 'Information Products' on hundreds of Radio Talk Shows
* How to "private label" your 'Information Products' for others
* **How to get 'Information Products' featured in Catalogs**
* How to use Card Decks

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HOW TO GET YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' ADVERTISED ON TV - IN "INFOMERCIALS"

* Transcript of my complete speech on The Infomercial Business from the famous Gary Halbert Key West College Of Millionaires Seminar, which direct marketing entrepreneurs pay $7,000.00 to attend.
* "Who's Who" in the 'Infomercial' Business
* How an infomercial deal is made
* How to submit your product or idea for consideration by "the right people"
* **The 14 Elements You Can Assemble That Virtually GUARANTEE Your Product Will Be Featured In An Infomercial - And Will Succeed On TV!** (This is our "insider list" used to evaluate and develop infomercials!)
* What to do if you've got a dynamite infomercial proposal but no money
* INSIDE...over a dozen infomercials, including BRIAN TRACY'S MAXIMUM PERFORMANCE SYSTEM HOSTED BY ROBB WELLER...THE MENTAL BANK BREAKTHROUGH WITH FLORENCE HENDERSON... ENTREPRENEUR MAGAZINE PRESENTS: BE YOUR OWN BOSS - WITH FRAN TARKENTON...PMS SELF-HELP SOLUTIONS HOSTED BY GLORIA LORING...etc. - including lessons learned from Millions Of Dollars invested in producing infomercials
* **How an infomercial can make you a millionaire "overnight"**
* The 5 biggest reasons why 9 out of 10 infomercials are flops
* The little-known, fortune-producing secret of the "2 step infomercial" - including "how my low budget, non-celebrity infomercial made 3-million dollars in 14 months."

HOW TO MAKE A LOT OF MONEY, BUILD WEALTH AND NET WORTH AND SELL 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' VIA THE NEWSLETTER BUSINESS

* Why the Newsletter Business may be the best business in the world!
* Advice directly from the most successful newsletter entrepreneurs in America
* How to get your newsletter advertised repeatedly in dozens of national magazines ABSOLUTELY FREE! (No front fees, no cost, no commissions to pay!!!)
* Why every speaker/seminar leaders hould publish and sell a newsletter
* **The "insider secret" to direct maketing subscriptions at 1/3 usual mailing costs**
* How to get established publications to "endorse" yours and help you sell subscriptions
* How I sold 3,000, $39.00 subscriptions in a few months, at a total cost of less than $7,000.00 - how anybody can copy my "model"
* How to slash newsletter publishing/production costs by 50%
* How to make $100.00 or more from each newsletter subscriber within 30 days after they subscribe
* How to get a "big company" to take over your newsletter business, multiply its size and pay you a lot of money for doing next to nothing.

HOW TO MAKE MONEY SELLING 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' AS A PROFESSIONAL SPEAKER

* 5 Ways To Establish And Promote Yourself, Your Credibility And Your Value As A Speaker
* Why and how being a "part-time" (not full-time) speaker" is a marketing advantage
* **Inside the Meeting Planner's mind: the 9 questions you must answer to get a speaking engagement**
* Your 12-Part Pro Self-Marketing "Tool Kit"
* 7 Keys to effective promotional materials
* All about "Demo Tapes" - including what 90% of the speakers do wrong!
* How to develop your "meeting Planner's Kit"
* **32 Directors + Agencies, Bureaus and Other Sources That Lead To Bookings**
* 4 Steps To Getting Speaking Engagements Via Direct-Mail
* **The 11 Different Ways To Structure Your Fees And Other Compensation As A Professional Speaker...how to average $3,000 to $5,000 per engagement**
* Why "Platform Selling" is the essential key to maxi-income from speaking
* 5 best "platform selling" techniques

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* 10 Keys to maximum at-speech product sales: **how I "close" 70% or more of every audience on 'packages' of $199.00 to $399.00...how I've taught other speakers to do the same or better...the only true "system" for platform, point-of-speech selling**
* What even high-paid, successful speakers who do well with "platform selling" still don't know about "platform selling"
* How to turn audience names into a productive, profitable mailing list
* A "Ready To Use" Presentation on Spaced Repetition (Cassette) Learning That Works
* "Client Penetration" for speakers: how to get multiple dates and tons of money out of each client...make more dollars from few clients with less hassle
* How to get Consulting Clients and Projects from Speaking Engagements
* An introduction to making a lot of money in the Consulting Business
* The 3-Ingredient "Secret" extracted from the "HOW TO GET BOOKED SOLID" SEMINAR presented by Keith DeGreen and Dan Kennedy repeatedly to appreciative groups of professional speakers

HOW TO MAKE MONEY SELLING 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' IN THE SEMINAR BUSINESS

* 5 Types of Seminars you can make money promoting
* 12 best ways to market ANY seminar
* 12 "tricks" for boosting attendance
* **My "5-Step Model" for seminar marketing**
* 10 ways to successfully promote "public enrollment" seminars
* How to eliminate the "no show" problem at "free" seminars
* How to make "free introductory seminars" pay off
* How to do "Executive Previews"
* How to market "big ticket," specialized seminars and retreats
* How to Sell Huge Amounts Of 'Information Products' At Seminars

HOW TO MAKE MONEY SELLING 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' BY PHONE

* New ways to make money and sell products via 'recorded message'
* How to get 'Information Products' telemarketed by professionals on commission - with no investment, no hiring, no hassle
* The Telephone Upsell
* Phone script tips
* **Everything about the amazing '900# Business'**
* How to get going in the 900# business for under $1,000.00
* How to get expert help in the 900# business - **free**

HOW TO MAKE MONEY SELLING 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' VIA MULTI-LEVEL MARKETING AND/OR HOW TO SELL A MULTI-LEVEL OPPORTUNITY BY MAIL

* Facts & Myths - all about "MLM"/Network Marketing'
* What you must know about "the legal issues"
* **Why "FundAmerica" was doomed from the beginning...LIES that most MLM promoters tell over and over again...what you should learn from this disaster**
* Why ENDEC was doomed from the beginning (and shame on the prominent NSA member who promoted this travesty to his colleagues)
* Special Information about "mail-order MLM"
* How to identify (or create) an MLM with a reasonable chance of survival
* An amazing Case History: meet the man earning over $250.00 a month in overrides by mail-order marketing an MLM opportunity and get his secrets!

HOW TO MAKE LOTS OF MONEY FROM THE MAILING LIST(S) YOU DEVELOP SELLING 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS'

* 3 ways to MAKE BIG MONEY, even from "small" lists
* Who will pay you 50 cents **per name?**
* How to sell your own lists without a broker

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* Where to advertise your lists and how to get **free** advertising for lists
* Why, when and how to do list "swaps
* How to average $10.00 or more per name per year from selling, renting and swapping your lists: 10,000 names puts $100,000 in your pocket!...100,000 names makes One Million Dollars!

HOW TO OPERATE YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' BUSINESS PROFITABLY AND EFFICIENTLY

* The fundamentals of Fulfillment
* Sub-Contracting: pros, cons, how-to's
* Doing It In-House; pros, cons, how-to's
* **How to get and keep a MasterCard/Visa Merchant Account**
* "A-to-Z" about: Product Packaging
* How to avoid tying up big bucks in inventory
* "A-to-Z" about: Costs, Mark-ups, Margins, Pricing
* How to decide on **the** best selling price
* 5 Common Pricing Errors
* Basic Business Forms
* Dealing with the U.S. Postal Service/Understanding Classes of Mail
* Fulfillment "cheap" with Educational Materials Special Rate
* Equipment you should consider getting
* **How to avoid stacking up overhead**

HOW INFORMATION ABOUT VENDORS AND SUPPLIERS FOR YOUR 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' BUSINESS

* **Best 'short run' book printers**
* How to self-publish books at amazing low costs
* **How to get Full-Color Printing at black and white prices**
* 29 "best sources" for goods and services you'll need
* My "Million Dollar Rolodex" - Who I Know and Rely On
* Comments about 'desktop publishing'
* 10 best ways to keep a lid on cost in this business

LEGAL INS AND OUTS OF THE 'INFORMATION PRODUCTS' BUSINESS

* **Save money with "do it yourself" copyright**
* Meet: the FTC, the FDA, the Postal Authorities, the State Attorney Generals
* What you need to know about the BBB
* How to stay out of trouble
* Errors and Ommissions and Product Liability Insurance
* The Corporate Shield
* Which 2 Dumb Mistakes keep sending shocked direct marketers to jail?

MISCELLANEOUS

* The little-known strategy: "What happens when you run out of places to advertise?
* Complete Dictionary of this business' terms
* "Who's Charging What" - how much should you pay experts for their assistance?
* Special information for inventors
* Trade Assoc.: which to join-surprising dangers of belonging-what you need to know.

There is no more complete, value-packed how-to text on the 'Information Products' business available anywhere, at any price.

Well, after going through the list on the previous pages, I'll bet you can understand why I've called this new publication and resource a "super

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book." It is filled with millions of dollars worth of "how-to's" applicable to any and every aspect of Information Products.

Now, here's my very fair, very generous offer:

Get my new super-book and take up to 30 days to go through it, page by page, word for word and if you are not a lot more than just "satisfied"...if you are not AMAZED and astounded at the immense value...if you are not ORGASMICALLY EXCITED about the strategies - I want you to return the thing for a full refund PLUS an extra ten bucks, out of my pocket, for your trouble.

(Sure, some incredibly cheap, unethical schnooks will stand at their Xerox machines for hours - or, worse, make their secretaries do it - copy the book, return it, and rip me off. There's nothing much I can do about such fiends. Karma'll get 'em.) If you want a refund, you get it. Plus $10.00. No questions asked, no hassles. You cannot lose.

So - how much is it? This huge book sells for $199.95. I guess that's quite a bit for a book. But I've received more unsolicited letters of praise from the buyers of this book than from any other book, or other information product I've ever put out mail-order novices and experienced pros alike tell me it'd be a bargain at ten times the price. If I wanted to, I think I could "air it out" into several manuals, cassettes, package it up as a "Course" and get $1,000.00 or more for it with no complaints. So I think its price is a terrific value. I guarantee you'll agree.

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Dan S. Kennedy

PS: Here are a few of my "best secrets" revealed in this book: the 2 ingredients that provide a Success Insurance Policy for ANY information product promotion...how to get world-class copywriters to work for you FREE (pay them only after they improve the results of your proven campaign)...how to save fortunes on media...my Million Dollar Directory of best vendors, experts...how to RAISE your price and sell more...the 14-point checklist that PREDICTS success or failure like a crystal ball...and much, much more! Any <u>one</u> of these could be worth $199.95 and then some to you. Don't fool around, don't go through unnecessary trial-and-error, don't waste time and money learning lessons the hard way, don't re-invent the wheel...take the smart shortcuts this super-book offers you!

WHAT 'DRIVES' THE MAIL-ORDER SALES?

Why do so many people FAIL in mail-order? One of the biggest reasons is an overall lack of understanding about what really drives the mail-order sale.

Most novices believe that their Product is the most important factor in their potential success. They are infatuated with their Product. They can't stop talking about how wonderful their Product is. Yet, the Product is actually of low-level importance compared to the other factors that drive the sale AND that lead to profitability in this business. Here are some of the most important elements, in my experience.

<u>#1: A "market" likely to buy, that can be reached efficiently and affordably.</u>

Last year, one of my companies did over $100,000.00 in mail-order sales to a list of less than 4,000 people; over three times that much to another list of only 28,000 people. And over the last several years, we've done over a half-million dollars in sales with that first, tiny list, and over a million with the second, bigger, but still limited list. How we accomplish this includes a simple "formula" for mail-order success that just about anybody can copy.

It so happens that I understand the people that make up these two lists like I know my wife, my closest friends, myself - intimately. I understand their needs,

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desires, fears, concerns, finances, daily activities. I "know" these two markets inside out and upside down. Because of that, two things become possible: one, I can create and/or find products that are perfectly matched with these individuals' preferences...and, in most cases, I do create them. Second, I can write advertising copy directed to these people that is also perfectly matched with their thoughts and feelings.

Both of these markets are highly specialized. Easily and affordably reached through small circulation trade magazines with low advertising rates and insert rates. On mailing lists and readily reachable via direct-mail. This lets me control my cost of sales.

If I had more "general" products and offers and had to use "general" advertising media to get interested people to identify themselves, then collect those names at great expense, then mail to them, I would need a much bigger marketing budget, more time, and take more risk to generate the same kind of sales volume I'm able to get from these two, carefully selected, specialized markets.

If you understand this 'market first, product second' formula, you'll be able to less expensively, more safely get various ideas and projects until you hit a winner.

#2: Easy to understand, "magic pill" products.

In the past two years, I've worked on two different direct marketing projects, both involving "solutions to pain." Take my word for it, all things were pretty much equal except the "core" of the "pitch" itself: in one instance, the "pitch" was that, through new knowledge, mild exercise, behavior modification, etc., you would be able to end and prevent back pain, neck pain, headaches, etc.

The other "pitch" is that by getting a little hand-held widget and rubbing it on the in-pain areas as instructed, the pain goes away in a few minutes. The second "pitch" is what I call 'magic pill' in nature. And it works 1000% better than the other approach.

Make no mistake about it: people want magic pills. Of course, it is a major challenge to find truthful magic pill stories to tell. And I do not ever advocate untruthful advertising. Every once in a while, a product comes along or can be created that can honestly be presented as a magic pill. It's also important to remember that people buy what they want, not what they need, and they buy on emotion, not logic, so you need emotional appeal tied to your product. I've got to want it. The further you stray from all this, the tougher your job and the less likely you are to succeed.

#3: Answers to skepticism.

I am privy to a considerable amount of insider data, focus group results and other information that reveals why people buy and don't buy, respond or don't respond, and I am here to tell you that, if you've picked a market likely to want what you offer, and if you've communicated to that market effectively, and they still do not respond it is usually because they do not believe you.

I believe people are being trained not to trust, more so with each passing day. Nixon taught us not to trust our Presidents. Jimmy and Jim and Tammy taught us not to trust our evangelists. The S&L scandal taught us not to trust our bankers. And on and on and on. And the media is always warning people about us. It takes an overwhelming effort, a preponderance of proof to overcome all this disbelief. I've compiled a Tip Sheet: 19 WAYS TO OVERCOME SKEPTICISM, which I'll be happy to send free to anybody who writes me and asks for it.

#4: Value but high margins.

A lot of novices lose money in mail-order because they do not understand the industry economics. Some are misled by various catalog-imprint, drop-ship and "dealer" schemes. It is impossible to make money in mail-order with products offering 50% to 100% mark-ups as your primary producst. (You can use such product to fill out catalogs, to promote via bounceback inserts in your own packages, articles in your newsletters, etc., to your established customers, but NOT as the main products you advertise to the public/to new, prospective customers.)

To use one-step print advertising, two-step print advertising and direct-mail, direct-mail or direct-response television you need at least an 800% (8 times) mark-up. That means what costs you a dollar must sell for eight dollars. Anything less than this is economic suicide. And, in most cases, a ten to twelve-times mark-up is needed.

This is one of the major advantages of building a mail-order business around "information products" like books, manuals, audio cassttes, video cassettes, home study courses and newsletters: you can have that kind of high mark-up and still deliver good value to the purchaser. Although I have used mail-order to sell award items, art prints, cosmetics, business opportunities, and other products and have helped clients in dozens of different fields, I have made "information products" my #1 specialty for this reason. And knock on wood, I've enjoyed considerable success in this field: my own businseses sell over a million dollars of information products a year; as a consultant and through joint ventures, I've been integrally involved in the

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sale of products marketed by Nightingale-Conant Corporation, Entrepreneur Magazine, Caddylak Systems, Hume Publishing Company, and on TV, the Guthy-Renker Corporation, and enjoyed wonderful working relationships with "giants" in direct marketing, like E. Joseph Cossman, famous for marketing 'The Ant Farm,' his mail-order home study course, and his 3-million copy best-selling book 'How I Made $2,000,000.00 In Mail-Order." Ted Nicholas, author of the famous book 'How to Form Your Own Corporation Without A Lawyer" and Gary Halbert, creator of the most mailed sales letter in history, I am thoroughly convinced that I could not have experienced comparable success in this industry had I concentrated my efforts on any other product specialty.

#5: The "back-end" is where the profit is really at.

The idea of coming up with one product and one ad and making a fortune from it is just about as antiquated as having your ad "typeset" by monks, carving it in rock. Almost every modern mail-order fortune is made by developing a clientele, a list of customers who have purchased from you, been well satisifed, know you, trust you and are predisposed to make repeat and additional purchases from you, time after time after time. To be in mail-order without a solid plan for repeatedly doing business with the same customers is foolish.

And having this intention in place, in your mind, helps drive the initial sale too. When you are seeking long-term relationships, you choose products, structure offers, write copy and make decisions differently than if you plan to "hit and run before the posse forms." I believe the higher quality thinking actually helps to drive the sale.